

ISMUN 4.0 **BACKGROUND GUIDE**

UNITED NATIONS HISTORIC SECURITY **COUNCIL**



Agenda: *Evaluating the Geopolitical Consequences and Human Rights Implications of the Soviet Invasion of Afghanistan.*

Freeze Date: *15th of February, 1989(tentative)*

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LETTER FROM THE EXECUTIVE BOARD

Hello Delegates!!!

On behalf of the Executive Board, we extend a warm welcome to all of you and congratulate you on being part of the Historic Security Council (HSC) for the ISMUN 4.0. This background guide has been created to help you with your research, and we promise that this background guide will provide a perfect launching pad to help kickstart your research. This being clear, we kindly ask you not to limit your research only to the areas highlighted in this background guide, but to push it to all related issues. Also, this background guide cannot be used as a source during the committee, and everything that is said in the committee must be backed with suitable evidence. Your goal should not be to reiterate existing solutions in the committee, but to put your mind to use for developing your own analysis of subject matters and bring forth novel solutions if possible. Don't worry, your points won't be deducted for not knowing the procedure during the committee, but we ask you to be well versed with the rules of procedure before the committee sessions, and an orientation session will be held for the same. Again, this is an advanced committee and you have been selected because we recognize your exceptional talent in MUNning! We look forward to viewing your diverse perspectives on the topic and expect exceptional debate.

All The Best!!!!

Regards from the EB,

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ABOUT THE COMMITTEE

Mandate:

The UNSC is one of the six principal organs established by the UN charter, which was signed on 26th June 1945 and brought into action on 24th October 1945.

Article 24 of the charter says that, UN member states confer upon the security council being the primary responsibility for the maintenance of peace and security.

According to the Charter, the United Nations has four purposes:

- to maintain international peace and security;
- to develop friendly relations among nations;
- to cooperate in solving international problems and in promoting respect for human rights;
- and to be a center for harmonizing the actions of nations.

The UNSC alone has the power to issue binding decisions that all member states must accept and carry out under article 25 of the charter.

Composition:

The Security Council is composed of fifteen member states. Five are permanent members (P5) China, France, the Soviet Union (now Russia), the United Kingdom, and the United States of America. These five nations hold veto power. Under Article 27, any substantive resolution requires the concurring votes of all five permanent members, meaning a negative vote from any one P5 blocks the resolution. The remaining ten seats are non-permanent members elected by the General Assembly for two-year terms. Please note that the non-permanent seats expanded from six to ten only in 1965.

Action In Case of Dispute:

In case of a hostile situation, the committee's main concern is to bring it to an end as soon as possible. In this case, the council may:

- issue ceasefire directives that can help prevent an escalation of the conflict;
- dispatch military observers or a peacekeeping force to help reduce tensions, separate opposing forces and establish a calm in which peaceful settlements may be sought.

Other than this, enforcement measures also include:

- economic sanctions, prohibition of arms, financial penalties/restrictions, and travel bans;
- severance of diplomatic relations;
- blockades
- or even collective military action.

Chief Concerns:

When addressing any crisis, the Security Council operates with several core concerns guiding its decisions.

- First and foremost is the prevention of escalation, the Council must act swiftly to stop a situation from spiraling into wider conflict or full-scale war.
- Second is proportionality, under Article 4, the Council prefers non-military measures (sanctions, diplomatic severance) before resorting to military action under Article 42, which is seen as a last resort.
- Third is minimizing civilian harm, even when enforcement action is authorized, the Council is expected to consider the impact on civilian populations and non-targeted states.
- Fourth is the preservation of unity among the P5, if divided, the Council cannot act effectively, and any single veto can paralyze the entire response.

- Finally, the Council must balance speed against deliberation – acting too slowly risks the crisis worsening but rushing without consensus risks illegitimate or counterproductive measures.

Powers:

The powers of the UNSC are stated clearly in chapter 6 and 7 of the UN charter.

- Chapter 6 (Peaceful Settlement): Article 33 states that all parties involved in a dispute must first try to resolve it through negotiation, mediation or any other peaceful means. Article 34 allows the Council to investigate any dispute.
- Chapter 7 (Enforcement of Powers): Under article 39, the council can only take binding action if there is a definite threat to the peace, breach of the peace, or act of aggression.
- Article 41 (Sanctions): The Council can impose measures not involving force – including economic sanctions, stopping communications, and cutting off diplomatic relations.
- Article 42 (Military Action): Article 42 allows military action including demonstrations, blockades, and any other operations by air, sea or land in case the measures provided by Article 41 are not enough.
- Article 51 (Self-defense): In case of an armed attack, countries have the inherent right to defend themselves individually or collectively. This right can only be exercised till the UNSC takes the necessary steps to re-establish peace and keep international security.

ABOUT THE AGENDA

THE SOVIET INTERVENTION IN AFGHANISTAN:

Afghanistan entered a period of political instability in the 1970s. In 1973 Afghanistan's King Mohammed Zahir Shah was overthrown by Mohammed Daoud Khan who then established a Republic. Daoud's own government was overthrown in April 1978 during the Saur Revolution. The new communist government was formed by the People's Democratic Party of Afghanistan (PDPA).

The PDPA government of Nur Muhammad Taraki undertook far-reaching reforms including those relating to land, education, literacy, marriage, the role of women, and the structure of Afghan society. While many of these were aimed at modernising Afghanistan, they were met with a lot of resistance, especially by the more traditional elements of Afghan society. Further, widespread arrests, executions and the increasing Soviet influence in Afghan affairs undermined the government.

The PDPA consisted of two main factions, the Khalq (associated mainly with Nur Muhammad Taraki and later Hafizullah Amin) and the Parcham (associated mainly with Babrak Karmal). This caused further instability when Hafizullah Amin ousted Taraki from power in September 1979. Taraki was subsequently executed.

Meanwhile, opposition to the PDPA was gathering pace. The opposition was made up of a number of different armed groups who shared some, but not always all, characteristics such as religious beliefs, political inclinations, ethnic or tribal affiliations or regional affiliations. These groups became known as the Mujahideen.

The worsening situation in Afghanistan and the possible loss of an ally prompted the Soviet Union to intervene. Soviet troops entered Afghanistan in December 1979, and Hafizullah Amin was killed. New PDPA leader Babrak Karmal was installed by the Soviets.

The Soviet Union argued that its intervention in Afghanistan was at the request of the Afghan government, and was a legitimate exercise of the rights of collective self-defence as provided for in the UN Charter. However, this interpretation was strongly opposed by many nations who saw the intervention as an unwarranted

breach of Afghanistan's sovereignty and territorial integrity and an assault on the rights of the Afghan people to determine their own future.

The intervention was condemned by the international community. Resolution ES-6/2 of January 1980, adopted by the General Assembly of the United Nations, strongly condemned the armed intervention by the USSR and called upon States to take measures consistent with their international obligations to ensure an immediate, unconditional and complete withdrawal of foreign troops from Afghanistan.

The conflict that ensued was one between the government and Soviet forces on the one hand and various Mujahideen groups on the other. The Soviet forces had a qualitative edge in terms of conventional military power. They controlled many of the major cities, military installations, airports and highways, while the Afghan government held on to the capital, Kabul. However, the rugged Afghan terrain meant that most of the countryside remained inaccessible to the Soviets and provided safe haven for the Mujahideen. There was also a huge variation in the types of military activity ranging from a concentration on aerial and helicopter assaults, combined with massive cannon and mortar bombardments of strategic positions, to regular and massive offensives by heavily armed Soviet armored columns and troops, combined with large-scale raids, and the use of air power. The Mujahideen countered with guerrilla warfare, made easier by their local knowledge of the terrain, and greatly aided by foreign contributions of various kinds. The acquisition of American-made Stinger anti-aircraft missiles by the Mujahideen in 1986 made Soviet aircraft and helicopters highly vulnerable. There were numerous other military, political, economic and diplomatic factors which affected the war.

Babrak Karmal was eventually replaced by Mohammad Najibullah who took over as leader of Afghanistan in 1986. His policy of National Reconciliation sought to achieve a wider political opening and to loosen the government's reliance on military force by negotiating a settlement with the opposition Mujahideen.

At the same time, the new Soviet leader Mikhail Gorbachev began to pursue a diplomatic solution to the conflict. This eventually led to the Geneva Accords of 14 April 1988 which provided for the phased withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan and addressed other issues, including intervention, international assistance, refugees and the future of the Afghan government.

GEOPOLITICAL CONSEQUENCES:

The Soviet intervention transformed Afghanistan from an internal political crisis into one of the most important international conflicts of the later Cold War. The conflict involved not only Afghanistan and the Soviet Union but also the United States, Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, Iran, China, India, and numerous other international actors.

For the Soviet Union, Afghanistan held considerable strategic importance due to its location on the Soviet Union's southern frontier; they wished to maintain a friendly government in Kabul, prevent the collapse of an important regional ally and avoid instability close to Soviet Central Asia. However, the prolonged military involvement placed political, military, economic, and diplomatic pressure on the Soviet Union.

The intervention became a significant escalation of the Cold War. For the United States, it was a major expansion of Soviet influence, so they increased support for the Afghan resistance. Under the covert programme called Operation Cyclone, the USA provided substantial assistance to the Mujahideen. Afghanistan became an important arena of Cold War fighting with Washington and Moscow.

Pakistan became one of the most significant regional actors in the conflict. The territory was both a refuge for millions of displaced Afghans and the principal logistical route through which foreign assistance came to many Mujahideen. Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence had an important role in distribution of assistance between the many resistance factions. They wanted to limit Soviet influence near its borders while maintaining significant influence over Afghanistan's future.

Saudi Arabia also provided considerable financial assistance to the Afghan resistance and cooperated closely with Pakistan and the United States. China opposed the Soviet expansion in Afghanistan and provided assistance to the elements of resistance while maintaining close strategic relations with Pakistan.

Iran had separate interests in the conflict. They hosted a substantial Afghan refugee population and maintained connections with sections of the Afghan resistance, particularly Afghanistan's Shi'a communities. They were also concerned about foreign interference in Afghanistan and the political composition of any future Afghan government.

India occupied a more complex diplomatic position. They maintained close relations with the Soviet Union while simultaneously having longstanding political and cultural ties with Afghanistan. India had strong interests in regional stability, limiting extremism, preventing excessive foreign interference and maintaining an independent relationship with Kabul.

As more external states became involved, Afghanistan increasingly became a proxy battlefield. The foreign governments supplied weapons, funding, training, diplomatic support, and other forms of aid to the competing Afghan actors. This raised questions about sovereignty and if the Afghan people could genuinely decide their political future while the rival powers continued to support their faction.

Another significant complication was the fragmented nature of the Mujahideen. Although the resistance factions shared opposition to Soviet military involvement and the Kabul government, they were very different in ideology, leadership, ethnicity, regional influence, religious outlook and relations with foreign governments. The lack of a united resistance leadership raised major questions about who legitimately represented the Afghan opposition and how the various factions could participate in a future political settlement.

The Soviet intervention also caused a significant deterioration of relations between the Soviet Union and the United States. International responses included economic and diplomatic measures and the American-led boycott of the 1980 Moscow Olympic Games. Afghanistan had become symbolic of the wider struggle between the two Cold War superpowers.

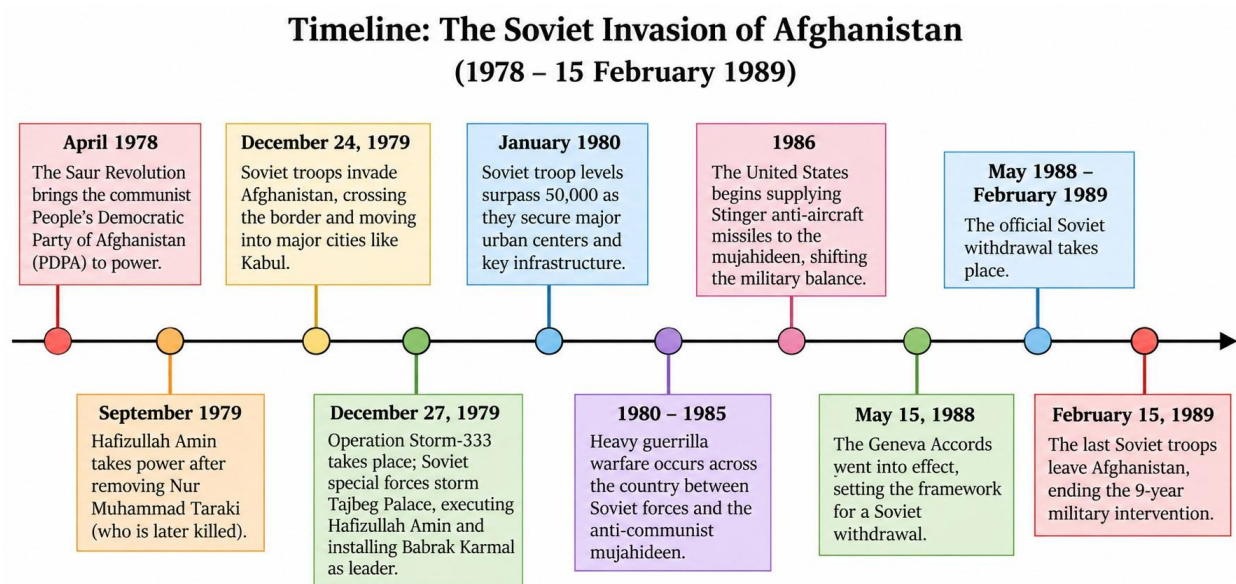
Diplomatic efforts eventually produced the Geneva Accords signed on 14 April 1988. Afghanistan and Pakistan were the principal signatories while the Soviet Union and the United States acted as international guarantors. The agreements addressed non-interference and non-intervention, international guarantees, voluntary return of Afghan refugees and arrangements connected with Soviet military withdrawal.

A significant limitation of the Geneva deal was that the Mujahideen were not direct signatories to the agreements. This raised uncertainty about if an agreement negotiated mainly between the governments would produce a lasting political settlement without directly incorporating the armed opposition.

The United Nations played an important role in the diplomatic efforts regarding Afghanistan. The United Nations Good Offices Mission in Afghanistan and Pakistan (UNGOMAP) was established to help implement the Geneva arrangements including monitoring of relevant commitments and the Soviet withdrawal.

However, the wider challenge went beyond the withdrawal of Soviet troops. The conflict raised fundamental questions about the future political structure of Afghanistan, continued foreign military assistance, the legitimacy of competing Afghan factions, regional security and the possibility of creating an Afghan-led political settlement.

TIMELINE:



COUNTRY-WISE STANCES

1. The United States of America (USA)

The United States took an extremely firm stand in opposition to the Soviet intervention. Washington believed that it was an illegal occupation of the territory of another country and an attempt to expand Soviet influence into South Asia and the Persian Gulf. The USA took a leading position among nations opposing the war, calling on the UN to take action. In addition, the CIA provided significant support to the Afghan Mujahideen through its “Operation Cyclone.” In particular, Washington supplied Stingers to the Afghan guerrillas in 1986. Moreover, the US blocked any military aid to the Soviet Union and adopted the UN resolution condemning the intervention. Nevertheless, the United States did not consider a complete withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan as a solution to the conflict. Washington did not want the PDPA government to remain in power without a political settlement. Thus, the US supports the Mujahideen and remains opposed to Moscow, but it also calls for a peaceful resolution of the conflict.

2. Union of Soviet Socialist Republics (USSR)

The USSR is the only foreign power directly involved in the conflict. Soviet authorities claimed that troops were sent to Afghanistan at the request of the Afghan government to fight against foreign-sponsored insurgents. Therefore, they do not consider the Soviet military presence in Afghanistan as an occupation. Moreover, it is worth noting that Moscow does not recognize the legitimacy of the Mujahideen as a fighting force. The USSR provided military, economic, and political support to the PDPA government throughout the war, despite changes in the leadership of the party (from Karmal to Najibullah).

At the same time, the USSR began to revise its position on the continuation of the war. According to the new policy guidelines, initiated by Gorbachev, the Soviet Union does not want to continue to spend resources on fighting in Afghanistan. Therefore, it agrees to withdraw troops from Afghanistan as stipulated in the Geneva Pact. However, the USSR intends to support the Najibullah government and does not want the Mujahideen to win. Hence, the USSR continues to provide aid to the PDPA and opposes foreign aid to the Afghan resistance.

3. China

China is strongly opposed to the Soviet intervention and considers it an expansion of Soviet hegemony. Beijing supports the UN resolutions on the withdrawal of troops from Afghanistan and voted for the resolution adopted by the UN General Assembly. At the same time, China supports Pakistan and provides arms to the Afghan Mujahideen. Thus, China adheres to a policy of opposing the expansion of Soviet influence and supporting the independence and territorial integrity of neighboring countries.

4. France

France condemns the intervention of the Soviet Union in Afghanistan and considers it a violation of the sovereignty and territorial integrity of another country. Paris supports the UN resolutions on Afghanistan and voted for the UN General Assembly resolution on the withdrawal of troops from Afghanistan. Nevertheless, compared to the US, France has always been more hesitant about adopting firm measures against the Soviet Union. Therefore, while supporting the UN, France has been more cautious in condemning the Soviet Union. However, by 1989, France supported the implementation of the Geneva agreements and Afghanistan's national sovereignty. In so doing, France emphasizes the role of the UN in promoting a peaceful settlement of the conflict and protecting Afghanistan's territorial integrity and national sovereignty. Since France is a permanent member of the Security Council, it can act as an intermediary between the US and the USSR.

5. United Kingdom (UK)

The UK takes a firm stand in opposition to the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan. London considers this intervention a violation of the sovereignty and territorial integrity of another country. Furthermore, Britain supports the UN resolutions on Afghanistan and voted for the UN General Assembly resolution on the withdrawal of troops from Afghanistan. Nevertheless, compared to the US, France has been more hesitant about adopting firm measures against the Soviet Union. Therefore, by 1989, Britain supported the implementation of the Geneva agreements and Afghanistan's national sovereignty. Furthermore, Britain supports a political solution to the conflict and a UN initiative to protect Afghanistan's territorial

integrity and national sovereignty. Thus, by 1989, Britain supported the complete withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan and the settlement of the conflict through negotiations between the warring factions. The UK also opposes the prolonged occupation of Afghanistan by Soviet troops and supports the protection of Afghan refugees.

6. Afghanistan

In this case, Afghanistan refers to the government in Kabul, which is opposed to the Soviet intervention. Thus, Kabul maintains that the Soviet military presence in Afghanistan is due to the request of the Afghan government to protect the country from foreign interference. Therefore, Afghanistan is opposed to any foreign involvement in its sovereignty. Consequently, Afghanistan opposed the UN resolution on the withdrawal of foreign troops from Afghanistan.

The current government under President Najibullah adheres to a policy of National Reconciliation, which implies a policy of persuasion and compromise with the Mujahideen. This policy is based on the position that, despite the USSR's help in repelling the Mujahideen, they cannot remain in Afghanistan. Hence, the Soviet Union must withdraw its troops from Afghanistan, as stipulated by the Geneva Pact. However, the National Reconciliation also implies that the USSR will not abandon the PDPA government and protect it from the Mujahideen. Thus, Afghanistan supports a political solution to the conflict and the protection of refugees. Furthermore, since the Mujahideen are still willing to fight, National Reconciliation allows the government to hold talks with them. Under the Geneva Accords, Afghanistan and Pakistan have committed themselves to respecting the sovereignty and territorial integrity of each other. Thus, Afghanistan has pledged to ensure that Pakistan does not provide the Mujahideen with any military assistance. However, in return, Pakistan must not interfere in the internal affairs of Afghanistan and expel the Soviet troops stationed on its territory.

7. Iraq

Iraq is in a relatively independent position in the context of the Soviet-Afghan conflict. Saddam Hussein's regime is neither completely allied to the Soviet Union nor does it fully support the US, Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, and China's positions on the conflict. The main goal of Bagdad's foreign policy is to promote its interests in

the region by balancing relations with the superpowers and ensuring Iraq's status as an independent regional power. Thus, Iraq is likely to oppose any foreign military intervention in a Muslim country and will advocate for a diplomatic and peaceful resolution of the conflict. At the same time, the USSR is Iraq's valued ally, and Baghdad does not want to spoil relations with it. Hence, while opposing the Soviet intervention, Iraq will hesitate to criticize its actions.

Another factor affecting Iraq's position on the Soviet-Afghan conflict is the Iran-Iraq war. Since its end in August 1988, relations between Iran and Iraq have been weak, and Saddam Hussein is highly unlikely to welcome any policy that promotes the interests of his rival. Thus, it is conceivable that Iraq will oppose any agreement that enhances Iran's influence over Afghanistan, as well as any foreign military intervention in general. Hence, while being highly critical of the Soviet intervention, Iraq will advocate for a diplomatic and peaceful resolution of the conflict with respect for the sovereignty and territorial integrity of the concerned states. In addition, Baghdad is afraid of the strengthening of Iran's influence in Afghanistan and will oppose any agreement that promotes Tehran's interests.

8. Germany

The Federal Republic of Germany opposes the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan and has supported the UN Security Council's positions on this issue. Bonn regards the armed intervention of the Soviet Union as a violation of international law and a spoiler of the détente policy. Furthermore, West Germany is cool to the policy of confrontation with the USSR, preferring a more sober assessment of the situation. Nevertheless, Bonn supports the UN resolutions on Afghanistan and voted for the UN General Assembly resolution on the withdrawal of troops from Afghanistan. By 1989, West Germany supported the withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan and adhered to the position of self-determination of Afghanistan. Bonn also supports the protection of the territorial integrity of Afghanistan and the protection of refugees. In addition to the UN and its resolutions, West Germany also supports a diplomatic political settlement of the conflict.

9. Saudi Arabia

One of the most consistent supporters of the Mujahideen is Saudi Arabia. Riyadh views the Afghan resistance movement as an opponent of communism, as well as an ally and partner of Pakistan. Saudi Arabia is one of the largest donors to the

Afghan Mujahideen and was one of the ten states that sponsored the UN resolution on the withdrawal of troops from Afghanistan.

In general, there is a high probability that Riyadh will advocate for a political settlement of the conflict with a considerable degree of Mujahideen participation in power. Nevertheless, Saudi Arabia is highly unlikely to accept a settlement in which the Soviet Union retains its dominance. At the same time, one should consider that Saudi Arabia is unlikely to object to the return of Soviet troops to the USSR. In addition, Riyadh will insist on protecting Afghan refugees and ensuring the territorial integrity of Afghanistan. It is also possible that Saudi Arabia will advocate for a comprehensive international diplomatic initiative within the framework of the UN.

10. Iran

Iran rejects the Soviet Union's interference in Afghanistan and pursues an independent foreign policy in the context of the conflict. Tehran does not support the Soviet intervention, as it views the USSR as an expansionist and revisionist country. At the same time, Iran does not support the US and Saudi Arabian policies toward Afghanistan and Pakistan. The Islamic Republic of Iran has many Afghan refugees and will oppose any attempt to establish a pro-Soviet government. Thus, Iran will support the withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan but will oppose the establishment of pro-American and pro-Saudi order in Afghanistan. In addition, Iran will oppose any interference in the internal affairs of other states in general and will advocate for a diplomatic and peaceful resolution of the conflict. Given the large number of Afghan refugees, Iran will support the protection of refugees and their safe return to their homeland. Since Iran is also a supporter of the UN, it will advocate for a peaceful resolution of the conflict within the framework of the United Nations.

11. Pakistan

Being an Afghan neighbor, Pakistan is one of the most interested states in resolving the conflict. Islamabad estimates the Soviet military presence in Afghanistan as a threat to Pakistan's national security. Thus, Pakistan will support any initiative for a political settlement of the conflict in Afghanistan. Pakistan is also one of the ten states that sponsored the UN resolution on the withdrawal of

troops from Afghanistan. In addition, Islamabad provides shelter for many Afghan refugees. Pakistan is also the main foreign supplier of arms, equipment, and military knowledge to the Mujahideen. The Inter-Service Intelligence agency of Pakistan is instrumental in distributing weapons and funds to the Afghan fighters. It is considered that Pakistan will support the withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan and will advocate for a political settlement of the conflict rather than its military resolution. Since the Mujahideen are directly opposed to the Soviet Union, they will participate in the settlement negotiations. Nevertheless, Islamabad will have difficulties with international recognition due to the Geneva Accords, according to which Pakistan and Afghanistan have undertaken to refrain from intervening in each other's internal affairs. Since Pakistan is a strong opponent of the Soviet Union, but at the same time is a close ally of the US and Saudi Arabia, Islamabad will advocate for a return to diplomatic negotiations. However, Pakistan will oppose any attempts to make Afghanistan a satellite state of the Soviet Union.

12. Niger

Niger is one of the ten states that sponsored the resolution condemning the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan. Being a developing country, Niger adheres to a policy of neutrality in the conflict between the socialist and capitalist countries. Thus, Niger will support the UN resolutions on Afghanistan, in particular those calling for the withdrawal of troops from the USSR. Niger will oppose any military intervention in the internal affairs of sovereign states and will advocate for a diplomatic and peaceful resolution of the conflict. In addition, Niger will promote the immediate return of refugees to their homeland, as well as the protection of territorial integrity and sovereignty of states.

13. Egypt

Egypt opposes the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan and supports the UN resolutions on this issue. Having established good relations with the US, Egypt will adopt a firm position in opposition to the Soviet intervention. At the same time, Egypt will oppose any military intervention in the internal affairs of sovereign states and will advocate for a diplomatic and peaceful resolution of the conflict. Moreover, Egypt will support the UN initiative to protect Afghanistan's territorial integrity and national sovereignty. Given Egypt's national interests, it will oppose

the expansion of Soviet influence in South Asia. Given Egypt's opposition to the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan, it is possible to suggest that it will support a political settlement of the conflict. At the same time, Egypt will not oppose the involvement of the US, Saudi Arabia, and Pakistan in Afghanistan's future development.

14. Poland

As of 15 February 1989, Poland is still a member of the Warsaw Pact and officially belongs to the Soviet Bloc, despite internal political changes in the country. Warsaw supports the Soviet course on Afghanistan and opposes the UN resolutions on this issue. Hence, Poland is likely to adopt a firm position in favor of the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan. At the same time, Poland will support the continuation of the Geneva negotiations on a political settlement of the conflict. Since the Soviet authorities will remain in power in Poland, they will support the withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan but will oppose their complete withdrawal. This position is based on the desire to protect the PDPA government, which is already weak. Thus, by 1989, Poland will support a political settlement of the conflict, but it will oppose the disbanding of the pro-Soviet government.

15. India

India occupies a relatively special position in the Soviet-Afghan conflict, given its status as a member of the Non-Aligned Movement and its excellent relations with the USSR. New Delhi will oppose the Soviet intervention in Afghanistan as an anti-democratic act against a sovereign nation. Nevertheless, unlike other Third World countries that have adopted a firm position in condemnation of the Soviet invasion, India will vote against the UN resolution on Afghanistan. Furthermore, New Delhi will oppose the expansion of Soviet influence in South Asia and will support the UN initiatives on the protection of sovereignty and territorial integrity of states. At the same time, India will protect its national interests by opposing Pakistan's expansion of military and political influence in Afghanistan. Hence, India will support the withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan but will oppose the disbanding of the PDPA government. Given its position on the rights of self-determination of nations, India will support a political settlement of the

conflict. However, New Delhi will advocate for a more active role of the UN in resolving the Afghan issue.

IMPORTANT TREATIES, AGREEMENTS AND RESOLUTIONS:

1. UN General Assembly Resolution ES-6/2 – The Situation in Afghanistan (14 January 1980)

Adopted soon after the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan, this resolution strongly condemned the military intervention in Afghanistan and called for an immediate, unconditional, and complete withdrawal of foreign troops from Afghanistan. Furthermore, it stressed the importance of Afghanistan's sovereignty and territorial integrity, as well as the right of the Afghan people to determine their political system. Resolution ES-6/2 was adopted by a vote of 104 to 18, with 18 abstentions.

2. Bilateral Agreement on Non-Interference and Non-Intervention – Geneva Accords (14 April 1988)

One of the four agreements comprising the Geneva Accords, the Bilateral Agreement on Non-Interference and Non-Intervention was signed between Afghanistan and Pakistan. It obliged the signatories to respect each other's sovereignty and not to interfere in the internal affairs of the other. The agreement was significant in the context of the Soviet-Afghan conflict because Afghanistan accused Pakistan of intervening in Afghanistan and providing support (both moral and material) to the anti-Soviet Mujahideen.

3. Bilateral Agreement on the Voluntary Return of Refugees – Geneva Accords (14 April 1988)

Another agreement of the Geneva Accords, the Bilateral Agreement on the Voluntary Return of Refugees, was signed between Afghanistan and Pakistan. It provided the framework for the voluntary and orderly return of Afghan refugees who had fled the war-torn country. The topic of Afghan refugees was especially pertinent in the context of the Soviet-Afghan conflict because millions of Afghans had sought refuge in Pakistan and Iran.

4. Declaration on International Guarantees – Geneva Accords (14 April 1988)

In terms of the Soviet-Afghan conflict, the Declaration on International Guarantees concerns the role of international guarantor states of the Geneva Accords. Adopted by the US and the USSR, this declaration provided the guarantor states with certain rights and responsibilities in relation to Afghanistan and Pakistan, which were signatories to the Geneva Accords. More specifically, the guarantor states pledged to respect the rights, undertakings, and obligations undertaken by Afghanistan and Pakistan in the Geneva Accords.

5. Agreement on the Interrelationships for the Settlement of the Situation Relating to Afghanistan – Geneva Accords (14 April 1988)

Also part of the Geneva Accords, this agreement specifies interrelations between states involved in the conflict, including Afghanistan, Pakistan, the USSR, and the US. It establishes the procedure and timeline for the withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan. Afghanistan and Pakistan were signatories, whereas the US and the USSR were witnesses to the signing of the agreement. In practice, the withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan commenced in May 1988.

6. UN Security Council Resolution 622 (31 October 1988)

This resolution approved the agreements related to the United Nations Good Offices Mission in Afghanistan and Pakistan (UNGOMAP). The UNGOMAP mission was mandated to facilitate the implementation of the Geneva Accords, as well as to monitor the situation in Afghanistan and Pakistan with regard to non-intervention, withdrawal of troops, and voluntary return of refugees.

7. UN General Assembly Resolution 43/20 – The Situation in Afghanistan and its Implications for International Peace and Security (3 November 1988)

This resolution addresses the implications of the situation in Afghanistan for international peace and security. It reiterated the need for respect for the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Afghanistan, as well as the right of the Afghan people to determine their political system and government of their choice with due regard to the principles of international law. Furthermore, it underlined the importance of promoting dialogue among Afghans, as well as of Afghanistan's

territorial integrity and national unity, as a means of achieving a broad-based government with the full participation of all Afghans.

QARMA (QUESTIONS A RESOLUTION MUST ANSWER)

1. How can the international community guarantee the sovereignty, territorial integrity and political independence of Afghanistan?
2. What steps should be taken to ensure the complete, verifiable withdrawal of foreign military forces from Afghanistan?
3. How can the continuation of foreign interference and external military support to rival Afghan factions be resolved?
4. What is the proper role of the United Nations Organization in monitoring the situation and facilitating a peaceful political settlement?
5. How could inclusive Afghan dialogue be initiated between the Afghan government, the Mujahideen factions and other Afghan groups?
6. What kind of all-encompassing and all-inclusive political settlement would let Afghans determine their own political future?
7. How can the international community prevent Afghanistan from becoming a proxy battlefield between regional and global powers?
8. What measures should be taken to ensure that civilians are not targeted, bombed, or otherwise subjected to military action, reprisals or other acts of violence?
9. How can a safe, voluntary, and dignified return of Afghan refugees from Pakistan, Iran and other countries be ensured?
10. What international mechanisms should be adopted to deal with landmines and unexploded ordnance and the impact on civilians and returning refugees?
11. How should allegations of torture, arbitrary detention, enforced disappearance and other human rights violations be dealt with?
12. What measures should be taken to ensure the humane treatment, release or exchange of prisoners and detainees held by the various parties to the conflict?

13. How can humanitarian organizations be given the assurance of safe and unhindered access to civilians in both government-held and Mujahideen-held areas?
14. What responsibilities should the USSR, the United States, Pakistan, Iran, Saudi Arabia and other outside powers have in regards to bringing about a peaceful settlement as opposed to further fueling the conflict?
15. What political, humanitarian and security measures are needed to pave the way for a durable peace, national reconciliation and reconstruction in Afghanistan?

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PAPERWORKS FOR THE COMMITTEE

1. POSITION PAPER:

It is a formal written document outlining a country's stance, history, and proposed solutions regarding a specific committee agenda topic.

2. COMMUNIQUE:

A communique in MUN is a formal written message sent by a country or group of countries to the Executive Board.

Communiqués can be used to request help or information, propose cooperation, negotiate, issue warnings, make diplomatic offers, or take actions related to the crisis. Unlike a resolution, a communiqué does not require the approval of the whole committee.

TYPES OF COMMUNIQUE:

1. Overt Communique:

An overt communique is an official and openly acknowledged communication or action. The country sending it does not hide its involvement. It can be used for official diplomatic requests, announcements, warnings, negotiations, or offers of assistance.

2. Covert Communique:

A covert communique is a secret communication or action where the country's involvement is meant to remain hidden. It may be used for intelligence gathering, secret negotiations, confidential assistance, or other actions that a country does not want publicly connected to.

3. Joint Communique:

A joint communique is issued together by two or more countries that agree to cooperate on a particular action or message. All participating countries must agree to the communiqué before it is submitted. A joint communique can either be overt or covert.

3. DRAFT RESOLUTION:

A Draft Resolution (DR) in MUN is a formal document containing the solutions and actions proposed by delegates to solve the issues being discussed in the committee. It is prepared by a group of countries and presented to the committee for debate and voting.

A Draft Resolution is usually divided into two main parts:

1. Preambulatory Clauses:

These explain the background of the problem and why the committee needs to take action. They may refer to previous UN resolutions, treaties, international laws and important events related to the agenda.

2. Operative Clauses:

These contain the actual solutions and actions that the committee proposes. They explain what should be done, who should do it and, where necessary, how it should be implemented.

No. of Authors and Co-Authors (If any) will be specified in the committee itself.

SAMPLE COMMUNIQUE GIVEN

Operation Trident's Wake
Joint Covert Communique

From: Kingdom of Netherlands, United States of America, United Arab Emirates, United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland

To: The Executive Board

Summary: The navy of the US and UK supported by the naval forces of UAE and Netherlands, will surround the P5 forces around Somali waters to outnumber the Russian Naval Forces. Also, we will bomb the regional coalition's offshore oil platform to secure the P5 forces from being driven into the trap.

Objective:

To negate the Russian naval presence identified in Crisis 3 (the unmarked corvette which has been established as being at least partially Yemeni/Chinese-connected) before it can serve to shield the hijacked vessel or interfere with the embargoed cargo's recovery, and prevent the P5-aligned cell from attempting to use that cargo against the regional coalition's offshore platform in the manner threatened in Crisis 4.

Part 1 - Encirclement:

- The combined American, British, and UAE naval forces, plus the Netherlands' single available frigate, will attempt to encircle the contested waters around the hijacked vessel's last known location.
- The task force's primary purpose is to outnumber and contain the mysterious Russian corvette and any potential reinforcements it may bring, denying it any option to flee back out to international waters without engaging the vastly superior coalition forces.

- The British carriers and the Dutch frigate will hold the northern and eastern approaches to prevent the corvette from simply fleeing back toward Yemeni territorial waters, which would make the pursuit illegal under international law.
- Meanwhile, the US carriers will maintain flight operations but hold fire on any engagement not explicitly targeting the corvette, balancing deterrence with deniability.
- If the confrontation escalates and the task force is forced to comment on the crisis in detail, the Americans will remind the public that their carriers' primary role is to ensure unrestricted access to the region, and that the engagement is not an act of war.

Part 2 - Platform Denial Strike:

- If the hijacked vessel follows through on the P5's threat to drive itself into the regional coalition's offshore platform as described in Crisis 4, the next course of action will be for the coalition's aircraft based on the carriers laid out in Phase 1 to strike the platform's extraction and storage facilities.
- This is an act of undeniable aggression, but one that should be officially framed not as an attack on the regional coalition's sovereign economic zone, but rather a preemptive act of platform protection .
- The hijacked vessel's hard-coded approach run would have allowed the P5 to use the cargo as a weapon against the coalition, with potentially catastrophic consequences to the workers on the platform.
- It is better to take a short-term economic hit to the regional coalition's production capabilities than to allow a single terrorist cell to slaughter a hundred energy workers in the name of political leverage.

Naval Assets Committed:

United States

-USS Nimitz (CVN-68), Nimitz-class supercarrier, positioned approximately 150 nautical miles offshore to remain outside the regional coalition's claimed economic zone while keeping its full air wing (F/A-18E/F Super Hornets, E-2D Hawkeye airborne early warning, MH-60R Seahawk helicopters for anti-submarine and boarding support) within strike range of both the hijacked vessel and the offshore

platform. The carrier's presence anchors the outer perimeter and serves as the task force's primary command-and-control node for Phase 2 authorisation.

- USS Mason (DDG-87) and USS Gravely (DDG-107), Arleigh Burke-class guided-missile destroyers, hold the western flank of the encirclement, equipped with Aegis combat systems to track the Russian-linked corvette and any accompanying vessels in real time, and tasked specifically with denying the corvette a westward escape route into open water.

- USS Normandy (CG-60), Ticonderoga-class cruiser, provides layered air-defence coverage for the full task force and carries additional vertical-launch capacity held in reserve, should the platform-denial strike in Phase 2 require follow-on suppression of any coalition point-defence systems protecting the platform.

- A single Los Angeles-class fast-attack submarine, deliberately unnamed in this communique for operational security, is positioned to monitor subsurface activity near the corvette's last known position, given concerns the vessel may attempt to evade encirclement by rendezvousing with a submerged asset.

United Kingdom

- HMS Diamond (D34), Type 45 destroyer, holds the northern flank alongside Dutch assets, its Sea Viper air-defence system tasked with covering the formation against any retaliatory air response from Yemeni-linked assets referenced in Crisis 3. Diamond's Sampson radar array also provides the task force's most capable long-range air surveillance, feeding targeting data to both British and allied assets.

- HMS Lancaster (F229), Type 23 frigate, operating in a dedicated surveillance role, shadowing the hijacked vessel's hard-coded collision trajectory at close range using towed-array sonar and visual tracking, ready to relay real-time targeting confirmation the instant Phase 2 is authorised.

- A Royal Fleet Auxiliary tanker, RFA Tidespring, is attached to the formation to sustain extended on-station endurance for the British and Dutch flank without requiring a return to port, given the sensitivity of withdrawing assets mid-operation.

United Arab Emirates

- Baynunah-class corvettes Al Dhafra and Mezyad form the inner perimeter closest to the contested coastal approach, chosen specifically for their shallow-draft

manoeuvrability in waters where larger US and UK vessels cannot safely operate. Both carry Exocet anti-ship missiles, held strictly in a defensive posture per the encirclement's rules of engagement.

-An Abu Dhabi-class corvette maintains forward reconnaissance nearest the platform itself, providing the task force's earliest possible warning if the hijacked vessel accelerates toward its collision course, and serving as the UAE's dedicated liaison asset with the regional coalition's own coastal patrol forces, given the UAE's existing bilateral relationships in the Gulf.

Kingdom of the Netherlands

-HNLMS Tromp (F803), De Zeven Provinciën-class air-defence and command frigate, serves as the coordinating node linking the UK's northern flank to the wider task force communications network, leveraging the Netherlands' NCAGS (Naval Cooperation and Guidance for Shipping) expertise, already active in the region under Operation Prosperity Guardian, to deconflict commercial shipping traffic away from the encirclement zone during the operation.

-HNLMS Karel Doorman (A833), already deployed under EUNAVFOR Aspides, is redirected from its standing logistics role to provide sustained fuel, ammunition, and medical resupply for the extended encirclement, given its Joint Support Ship design is purpose-built for exactly this kind of multinational sustainment task.

Conclusion:

Therefore, Operation Trident's Wake represents a calculated, two-phase response designed to neutralise the immediate Russian-linked naval threat while denying the pirate cell any strategic advantage from its threatened detonation. Phase 1 secures the tactical initiative through encirclement rather than confrontation, preserving deniability and avoiding unnecessary escalation with Russian forces. Phase 2, while carrying genuine diplomatic risk given the regional coalition's explicit warning, is framed and executed as a protective denial measure rather than an act of aggression, prioritising the platform's personnel and long-term reconstruction over short-term production losses. Signatories accept that success depends entirely on Phase 1 forcing a stand-down before Phase 2 becomes necessary, and commit to simultaneous, transparent coalition notification should escalation prove

unavoidable. The United States, United Kingdom, United Arab Emirates, and Kingdom of the Netherlands submit this communique in the shared interest of securing the hostages, recovering the embargoed cargo, and containing this crisis before it draws in further state actors.